management company.) This ETF is meant to follow the Russell 1000 and claims to have less than 50 per cent carbon intensity (which in simple terms is the amount of carbon dioxide it takes to make electricity). Sounds great for someone who wants to invest in clean energy, right?

However, after looking at their holdings, you'll realise the ETF invests in Chevron, which was partly responsible for spilling 77 million litres (17 million gallons) of petroleum and 18 billion kilos (18 million tonnes) of toxic waste in Ecuador. Not quite the environmentally friendly fund you may have had in mind.

***It's important to not only be an ethical investor, but a vigilant one too.***

Investors in training are aware that they cannot trust something to be ethical without researching it themselves and making their own judgements. Often, just by looking at a company's holdings, you'll see each company listed by its 'weight' in the fund, for example, FUND ABC is made up of:

- Apple: 10 per cent
- Google: 5 per cent
- Tesla: 4 per cent, etc.

If you're researching a fund, make sure you check out that fund's holdings to ensure they meet your criteria.

## Investing and activism

As an investor you can vote for change with your money, pouring more into the issues and brands that you care about and actively choosing not to support companies that go against your beliefs.

It has never been easier for investors to get into the stock market, and it has also never been easier for groups of people to collectively stand together on issues they feel are important. Put them together and suddenly you've got a platform that corporations will listen to.

We can often feel helpless against large corporations, and they only seem to be getting bigger and more powerful. I'll let you in on a little secret, though.